

Book Report: E.M. Bounds

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Book 1: Power through Prayer

This was my favorite book of the EM Bounds literature. The reason is because it talked about the description of a man who is a man of prayer. It talked about the reverend, who is fully devoted to God, and his character. This character attracted me, and I want to become like this type of person.

Some of the things that is said in the book is, "the man makes the preacher. God must make the man." "Preaching is not performance of the hour, but the outflow of a life." "Clothed in humility, abiding in meekness, wise as a serpent, harmless as a dove."

I absolutely loved this last quote. I felt it described the truly worldly (in the world yet not of the world) type of preacher, who can manage the worldly things and conquer, but still be gentle like a Jesus disciple.

What I felt the book was describing, as a summary, was the depiction of a man who is completely dedicated to God and to praying. When we do this, the power of God and the power of prayer is manifested in our lives. We become a person, not of this world, we become a person, who is supernatural and different. Truly, the greatest people in this world have not been those who forced their agenda down people's throat, but the gentle, and who gain their power through power and from the Spirit. As the Bible says, "Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit." This is ultimately the depicting of the power of prayer. It is a power that people may not understand. It is a power that people do not suspect. It is a power that is unexpected and people think that it is weak and unnecessary, but the most necessary thing and the most important thing is prayer.

To truly be a minister of God, for myself, I need to understand the power of prayer. I need to understand that without prayer I am nothing. As the Bible says, "Abide in me, and if you don't abide in me, you can do nothing," (John 15). I worship the Lord Jesus. He is so great that without him, I am nothing. This shows that the "all surpassing power of God belongs to God." This great power is what will help me (Ephesians). This power will propel me to do all sorts of mighty works that glorify his name. The Bible says Jesus was led to the wilderness to be tempted. It says that Paul was filled with the Holy Spirit. This filling and leading is the power of God that we are talking about when we talk about the power of prayer. The power of prayer is not just a concept that E.M. Bounds created, but is biblical.

Book 2: Prayer and Praying Men

The works of EM Bounds is something of a miracle. In it, we see really great stories about the people of God. This is especially true in the section of Prayer and Praying Men. One of my favorite praying, man, and one of my favorite men of God is John Wesley. This man shows up in the book of EM bounds in this section. It says that "Wesley at 86 could still preach on the streets for 30 minutes." it also says that "Christianity was born again in England under his mighty preaching."

It is an astounding thing to see how a single man can change an entire nation. It has been sent by many historians that England would have fallen and disappeared from history if it had not been for John Wesley. John Wesley has been one of my favorite Christians in history. John Wesley is the founder of the Methodist church. John Wesley was a great man of prayer.

However, as great as Wesley is, there is a man who is may be greater than John Wesley. And that man is Jesus Christ. Also, Paul, the apostle may have been greater as well. In first Corinthians chapter 12 Paul talks about how he speaks in tongues more than anybody else. Actually, this may be chapter 14. What we find is Paul the apostle was a man of prayer as well. And although I don't remember reading about Paul, the apostle in this section of Bound's book, I'm almost certain that he does come up. Paul the apostle must have prayed daily just as Jesus has prayed. In fact, I wouldn't be surprised if Paul, the apostle prayed more fervently than Jesus. This is because Paul the apostle did more things - did greater works than Jesus.

In fact, Paul, the apostle himself says that he worked harder than any of the other apostles . And the question is, is Paul doing this in the flesh or in the spirit? And we know the answer to this question because it was Jesus himself he said that he would have to let Paul know how much he would have to suffer for the gospel. That means the many trials and hard work that Paul does is a command from God.

And we can know that the energy that Paul has for all of these things comes from prayer and a close communion with God. We know this because in the first Corinthians, it talks about how Paul prays more than anybody else.

In my life as well, I find that the more I pray the more energy I have. The more I pray the more great works I can do for the Lord. And the question is, how do I pray more and how do I keep praying a lot? And the answer to the question is there is no perfect answer but one answer is we can read the Bible. Reading the Bible, we develop our faith and connected with God even Paul the apostle said that he would read the Scriptures and for the Scriptures when he was in jail.

Book 3: Essentials of Prayer

The next section is called the Essentials of Prayer. The first section of this book is prayer takes in the whole man. There are many quotes that I can use, but it is all regarding the fact that prayer takes in the whole man. "Prayer takes in man in his whole being mind soul and Body." This quote essentially means that prayer must be done by the entire being. A Bible quote that supports this is the love the Lord your God with all your heart mind and strength. I believe this verse comes up in the Torah. Some people pray using their mouth some people pray using their mind. Some people pray using just one or two parts of their body. But I pray using tongues and what this verse is saying is that we need to pray with everything that we've got. Prayer is not something we just do occasionally - it is life itself. And so exercise is prayer and we all need to exercise. And our body movements, our body posture the way we sit the way we present ourselves to other people. This is all our prayer to God. We need to use all of our body all of our mind all of our soul for the prayer of God.

Another quote is "there are men of old who have brought the largest things to pass." This quote shows that great things can be possible through prayer. And the question is how come some peoples prayers are not causing great things to happen and some other peoples prayers are causing great things to happen. The answer to that question according to this book would be that some people are praying with all fervency and sincerity, and with passion and with power. And it is this type of prayer that causes great things to happen according to this quote.

Another quote is "holiness is wholeness, and so God wants holy men." One of the things that I told my friend that UCLA was that I wanted to be whole. I felt like there were parts of me that were broken and some parts of me that were empty. I just hated that feeling. And it is true that God wants me to be whole. The whole meaning of shalom is a wholeness. salvation is a wholeness. Holiness is wholeness according to this quote. This is a difficult thing to interpret

but what I want to say this means is that holiness is regarding the entire man. The holiness must be part of every aspect of life. The way we eat and drink must be done to the glory of God as it is said by Paul the apostle in the Bible.

Book 4: The Necessity of Prayer

The next book is called prayer and faith. This is one of my favorite sections. The reason is because the quote by AC Dixon is so powerful Dixon quote talks about how there was a guy who found a dog who was being captured by other dogs and this dog came to the man and began to beg for help, and this man began to have sympathy on the dog and protected the dog. This quote shows that something that is pitiful and weak the sympathy of a higher power. I think this is so true and our lives where God has almighty and so powerful, and he even created us, and when he sees that we are whimpering and coming to him and bowing before him and asking for help, he cannot relent and keep away from punishment and heal us and heal our land.

We must understand that we are weak and small. We must always seek the protection of God above. If we ever act strong and self-sufficient, then those other dogs and Satan will destroy us. This prayer where comes in. Prayer is when we acknowledge that we are humble and submissive to God. Prayer show God that we are humble and ready to listen. Prayer shows that we submit to the Lord Almighty. Therefore prayer is the agent for change. prayer is the agent for healing. Prayer will save our lives. Prayer will grant us the desires of our heart. And this can only be done in Faith without faith we cannot, please guide, according to the Bible. Without faith, we cannot pray in this way. And Faith is a grace from God. It is a gift from work so that anyone can boast according to Ephesians. We must understand that everything comes from God.

The next quotes that comes after this shows this fact in better understanding. The quote is "he must believe, where he cannot prove." what this is saying is that we cannot prove things we cannot have fact we cannot see the things that are required of Faith. That is why faith exist. Because we cannot see because we cannot prove we must have faith. Therefore, we come to God, empty-handed, weak and submissive like a dog and so weak. We cannot see, we are not omnipotent. And so we come in faith and we come in prayer.

Book 5: The Possibilities of Prayer

"Prayer should be the breath of our breathing, the thought of our thinking the soul of our feeling." This quote is by Homer W Hodge. Although this is an abridged version of the quote, the general gist of the quote is that prayer should be every part of our life every every every every part of our life. What this means is that prayer is not this little rote or kind of mechanical action where you close your hands with both hands and you kind of say some kind of written text that you memorized.

No, not at all. Prayer can't even be just the emotion. Just a thought of love. Prayer can be done by a mentally ill person who cannot think clearly. Prayer can be done by a retarded person who cannot think clearly. Fair can be done on the bus. Prayer can be done in your sleep. Prayer can be done in the shower. Prayer can be done at all times and in all ways. The punchline is this: when we pray and everything we do, we are building up strength, and every second of our lives. we are not wasting a second. We are putting on the full armor of God and being vigilant we find spiritual war every second we are putting on love, gentleness and kindness.

What I mean is this: some of the greatest mistakes that people make when they are not and are not careful. This is why prayer at all times in every way is so important. We must be vigilant. And when we put on love in the shower when we put on love in our dreams when we

put on love on the bus, we are learning how to love in every way possible, and putting love on every aspect of our lives and we are winning the spiritual war. Does that minister have so great of a ministry? How does that man achieve so much? And the answer is most likely that he prays at all times and he prays correctly and he prays well. And once again, I just wanna say the verse that comes to mine which is if you do not abide in me then you can do nothing, which is in John 15. We must understand that God is the one who provides the change and so we must hold fast to God and pray always.

In my life, I find that prayer was lacking in my past. But recently, I discovered the beauty of prayer. Now I pray one or two hours a day. I'm so happy praying that prayer is connecting with God and accessing the spiritual world. It is the seed of change. One may ask how can a mountain be moved and put into the sea. In the Bible says prayer. My logic tells me it's because prayer is the agent of change because it is a seed. It is planted and weakness and raised to glory, according to Corinthians.

Book 6: The Reality of Prayer

The beginning quotes of the first section of the book of this section doesn't seem to be related to prayer in my eyes, but I shall speak of it. This quote talks about going to God and going to eternity and how the person who is speaking wants to know how to get to heaven. John Wesley, who is the speaker of this quote says he wants to get the book of gone at any price because it tells of how to get to heaven and this is where I think it relates to prayer: he says that thy word says if any man likes wisdom, let him ask God. Therefore, we shall ask of God.

To relate all of this quote to prayer, we must focus on the fact that we must ask God for wisdom. But one of the things I want to focus on the way to heaven. The right approach to life and spirituality is to understand the way to heaven. When we pray, and when we live our life,

we may go in many directions. As we will see later, there is also intercessory prayer, which is even another direction and many directions we can take in our prayer. But the question is which direction are we supposed to go and which direction is the best? In the answer is the way to heaven as the quote talks about.

When I look at my life, I need to ask myself. Am I doing it to get to heaven or am I doing it to do some worldly thing? If it is not to get to heaven, then it is useless. And this is exactly the wisdom that God gives when we ask him for that wisdom. To be honest, I believe I have the wisdom from God that is pure like milk. The reason is because I have read the word diligently. The wisdom is this: to focus on heaven. Wisdom will allow us to see clearly what is important and what is not important. Wisdom will allow us to see spiritual things and not earthly things. Wisdom is not some strange idea, but includes physics and science. Must not reject science and all of these earthly wisdom because God made the world through wisdom. And the greatest prayers we can pray, is a prayer for wisdom.

There are several types of prayers that the book talks about. There is supplication and intercession. Supplication in my opinion is asking God of things. And according to the videos of our class supplication is like a bird that is stretching out its head with all of its strength to get the worm or the kind of food from the mother bird we are stretching out our arms and stretching on our mouth in our heads to God to receive what we are asking from him.

Book 7: Purpose in Prayer

The quote that starts off the chapter, talks about how prayer is efficacious. It states this because there are times when we think otherwise - that it is not effective. As it says in the quote, there are times when we hurry prayer or neglect it because we do not see the power in it. And I want to say, this is the life of me in the past. And I believe that at times, prayer is not the right thing to do - there is a time for everything, and sometimes we got to be quiet and listen,

other times, we have to drive a car with defensive driving and think on our feet. But I understand that thinking that prayer is a waste of time is wrong. We should think that prayer is always a wonderful thing to do when it is called for.

The Bible says The eyes of the Lord run throughout the whole earth and he shows himself strong on behalf of those who put their trust in Him. We must trust in these kinds of verses, because these verses show that God is listening and is actively helping those who are actively seeking him. The contrary is that if we do not seek the Lord, the Lord will not help us. This is the wisdom from above - to believe that God is listening and to pray always.

We should understand that the world is shaped by prayer. And that the prayers of the past will shape the future. Thus, “prayers outlives the lives of those who uttered them.” This is so true, because my mother’s prayers helped my life (although she is still alive). And the prayers of the saints in the past, like Paul the Apostle, have shaped my life. And prayer shapes the world around us because prayer plants a seed of change in the world. If we pray, we initiate a change - a change that can be very large.

Book 8: The Weapon of Prayer

The prayer of the quotes of the section is calling out to the Lord and knowing that the Lord will say here I am. This is the confidence that we have that the Lord is listening to everything that we pray about. Surely if we have any concerns, we can ask him. Truly, which Philippians says, “Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by supplication and prayer, present your requests to God and the peace of God which transcends all understanding will guard your hearts and mind in Christ Jesus.” This promise is true. I have never experienced that peace for a long time or at least I thought I didn’t. You see, when I was at UCLA I had schizophrenia, and schizophrenia was very difficult. I had no peace. I would pray to God and ask this prayer promised, but I still wouldn’t have peace and would have difficulty. But the

peace of God is different from the peace of this world. It is not something superficial and something you can feel on the surface. It is something that is down at the root core of the matter, even though you do not feel it, just look around you and see if you're alive, if you're healthy, if you're able to eat every day and you'll see that the peace of God is guarding you. And what I found is that as I continued this journey of the pilgrim's progress, I found that that peace would grow and grow and grow from the root, I would feel that superficial and full piece that I longed for. I say that the peace of God which transcends all understanding is guarding my heart and mind in Christ Jesus. I have that full peace and I enjoy the communion with God. One of the things in this book talked about is how some prayers may not seem to be answered. But I would like to say that prayer is not about it being answered or not answered. It is about being listened to because prayer is about pouring out your heart and your thoughts and your concerns to God and having God listen to it and answer it in the way that he desires. And the goal of life is not to obtain something but just to be with God.